

Business Foundations Specialization: Introduction to Marketing



ABOUT THIS COURSE:

Taught by three of Wharton's top faculty in the marketing department, consistently ranked as the #1 marketing department in the world, this course covers three core topics in customer loyalty: branding, customer centricity, and practical, go-to-market strategies.

You'll learn key principles in

- Branding: brand equity is one of the key elements of keeping customers in a dynamic world in which new startups are emerging constantly.
- Customer centricity: not synonymous with customer service, customer centricity starts with customer focus and need-gathering.
- Go-to-market strategies: understand the drivers that influence customers and see how these are implemented prior to making an investment.

COURSE SCHEDULE:

MODULE 1 – BRANDING: Marketing Strategy and Brand Positioning

Professor Kahn starts us off with the first of two Branding modules: Marketing Strategy and Brand Positioning. For an overview of all concepts covered in the course, please read the syllabus below. Additional info may be found in the Course Pages. Please participate in the discussion forums as your input will enhance the overall experience of this course!

Course Pages

- Reading: Syllabus
- Reading: Frequently Asked Questions
- Reading: Additional Readings

BRANDING: Marketing Strategy and Brand Positioning

- Marketing 101: Building Strong Brands Part I (15:10)
- Marketing 101: Building Strong Brands Part II (4:10)
- Strategic Marketing (11:40)
- Segmentation and Targeting (12:47)
- Brand Positioning (12:50)
- Brand Mantra: The Elevator Speech (9:42)
- Experiential Branding (13:26)
- Quiz: Quiz #1

MODULE 2 – CUSTOMER CENTRICITY: The Limits of Product-Centric Thinking & The Opportunities and Challenges of Customer Centricity

Module 2 of our class features Professor Peter Fader, who will focus on concepts related to Customer Centricity. In an economy that is increasingly responsive to customer behaviors, it is imperative to focus

Business Foundations Specialization: Introduction to Marketing



on the right customers for strategic advantages. The coming weeks will provide the foundation needed to build a customer centric outlook. If you want to read more about Professor Fader's views on customer centricity, feel free to follow him on Twitter (@faderp). He regularly shares relevant perspectives and readings there.

- From Product-Centric to Customer-Centric Management (15:25)
- Cracks in the Product-Centric Approach (9:49)
- Data-Driven Business Models (4:26)
- Three Cheers for Direct Marketing (3:51)
- Which Firms are Customer Centric (12:11)
- What is Customer Centricity? (11:28)
- Living in a Customer-Centric World (14:48)
- More Reflections on Customer Centricity (3:21)
- Questions on Customer Centricity (6:00)
- Quiz: Quiz #2

MODULE 3 – GO TO MARKET STRATEGIES: Online-Offline Interaction & How to Find Lead Users and Facilitate Influence and Contagion

Professor David Bell takes over this week as we begin our third module! We are shifting focus to the critical topic of "Go to Market Strategies." The "go to market" strategy offers more possibilities than ever before as companies have the potential to address consumers both offline and online through a variety of platforms. Professor Bell has been able to work on these very issues with several exciting startups and will use those experiences to help illustrate this week's material.

- Introduction and Execution (2:09)
- Online/Offline Competition (4:51)
- Friction (4:39)
- The Long Tail Part 1 (10:58)
- The Long Tail Part 2 (9:55)
- Preference Isolation (14:36)
- How Internet Retailing Startups Grow (12:19)
- Customers and Digital Marketing (9:49)
- Influence and How Information Spreads (11:02)
- Pricing Strategies 1: Introduction (11:14)
- Pricing Strategies 2: Customer Factors (12:29)
- The 7ms (9:08)
- Quiz: Quiz #3

MODULE 4 – BRANDING: Effective Brand Communications Strategies and Repositioning Strategies

Professor Kahn is back in this fourth module, the second of her Branding Modules, covering effective brand communications strategies and repositioning strategies. Understanding how customers perceive

Business Foundations Specialization: Introduction to Marketing



your brand messaging and marketing is one of the most important aspects to understanding consumer behavior: what consumers perceive is what affects their actions, and what they perceive is not necessarily true! Professor Kahn unpacks customer behavior and perception and explores successful strategies for influencing both in this final required module of the course.

BRANDING: Effective Brand Communications and Strategies and Repositioning Strategies

- Brand Messaging & Communication (12:06)
- Brand Elements: Choosing a Brand Name (19:57)
- Brand Elements: Color & Taglines (11:41)
- Brand Elements: Packaging (10:09)
- Brand Elements: Persuasion (13:59)
- Repositioning a Brand (18:58)

Final Materials

- Final Exam

MODULE 5 – Applied Marketing (Optional)

These short lectures apply marketing principles taught in the course to current examples. Content in these lectures may deepen your understanding of course concepts but won't be tested directly on the quizzes or exam.

- The Brand Named Jennifer (2:15)
- Awesomeness TV (1:17)
- Playboy in China (1:19)
- Crocs (1:59)
- Barriers to, and Challenge of, Customer Centricity (5:08)
- Pay It Forward: Google and Others (3:08)
- CLV: Electronic Arts (3:02)
- Rewarding CLV: Merial (4:08)
- Customer Analytics Initiative (3:32)
- New Start-Ups in Customer Centricity (4:26)

TIME COMMITMENT: 1-4 hours per week

PASSING GRADE: 70% or greater on all assignments